

“What is our alternative now?” Linn asked as she moved to put Jordan in his crib.

“Looks like we only have one. God stopped us from filing bankruptcy by removing any excuse we might have had. The debts we owe are a result of our own decisions, and I can’t blame anyone but myself. I don’t see how we can do anything but commit to paying all our debts.”

“But how will we be able to do that on your salary alone?” Linn asked.

“I don’t think we can. I’ll just have to tell the school that I need to start looking for a new job. In the meantime I’ll go to each of the creditors and ask for a reduced payment until I can generate more income. But we can’t do much about the garnishment. That will come out of each paycheck until the bill is paid in full. It won’t leave us a lot to live on, but we’ll have to learn to do it. I want to cut up the credit cards, too. As long as we have them, we’ll be tempted to use them. And I think we need to go back to driving one car. Maybe we can sell my car for enough money to clear the Visa and the garnishment.”

“But my car has nearly 100,000 miles on it. Can we get by with a car that old?”

“We’ll have to,” Jackson said. “It’s going to be tough for a while, but as I said, we’ll just have to do it.”

Jackson left the Christian school for a job as a teacher and coach at a public school. He and Linn went to see the financial coach Nick had suggested and worked out a plan with the creditors that allowed them some transition time. It was nearly two years before they began to see daylight in their finances, but in three years they were totally free of their consumer debt.

They developed a course on finances and budgeting and have taught it in their church. And before any couple can get married in their church, they must go through the classes on how to manage money God’s way and then demonstrate that they can live on a budget. Jackson’s desire is to one day be the head of a Christian